

THE VOYNICH DECODER: OPERATING MANUAL

Welcome. If you are holding the manuscript and the physical 5-ring decoding wheel, you have everything required to read the text. You do not need to memorize any special alphabet codes or run complex calculations. This manual explains how to set the wheel, line up the shapes on the page, and read the decoded words.

1. What's in Your Hands

1. **The Book:** Written in a unique medieval script alongside drawings of plants, astronomical wheels, bathing pools, and interconnected circular diagrams (rosettes).
2. **The 5-Ring Wheel:** A physical brass or 3D-printed tool with five concentric rings that rotate independently around a central axis:
 - **Ring 1 (Outer Ring - Symbols):** Contains exact copies of all the unique shapes and symbols written in the book.
 - **Ring 2 (Word Starters):** Groups common letter combinations that begin words.
 - **Ring 3 (Core Stems):** Contains the main body and roots of words.
 - **Ring 4 (Word Endings):** Contains common word endings and suffixes.
 - **Ring 5 (Inner Ring - Solution Register):** The target translation layer, split into two reference tracks:
 - **Hebrew Track:** Spells out underlying Semitic/Hebrew root letters for structural and big-picture concepts.
 - **Latin Track:** Spells out Medieval Latin medical abbreviations for recipes, physical actions, and practical descriptions.

2. How to Set Your Wheel (The Two Alignment Dials)

Before reading words on a page, you must "tune" the wheel so the rings align correctly for that specific section. Think of it like turning a dial on a vault lock.

Alignment Key 1: The Outer Dial (Page & Diagram Position)

Look at where the text is located on the page:

- **Standard Paragraphs (Herbal & Plain Text):** Leave the outer ring at its default top position (12 o'clock).
- **Circular Maps & Rosettes:** Turn the outer ring to match the position of the diagram on the page.
 - If decoding a label in the **Center Hub**, leave it at 12 o'clock (0 degrees).
 - If decoding a label in the **Lower-Left (Southwest) diagram**, rotate the outer ring a quarter-turn clockwise to 3 o'clock (90 degrees).
- **Margin Clocks:** If a page features a small drawing of a clock, compass, or dial in the margin (such as the tiny dial in the bottom-left margin of the 9-Rosette foldout map), turn your outer ring to mirror the angle shown by its pointer hands.

Alignment Key 2: The Inner Dial (Handwriting & Paragraph Starters)

Look at how the paragraph or section begins:

- **Decorated Header Letters:** Large, tall, key-like shapes (often called "gallows" letters) at the start of a paragraph tell you where to lock the inner secondary dial.
- **Handwriting Changes:** If the style of handwriting shifts noticeably across different sections, nudge the secondary dial slightly left or right to match the scribe's specific shorthand style for that chapter.

3. Step-by-Step Decryption Process

Once your two dials are locked for the section you are reading, follow these steps for every word:

1. **Find a Word:** Choose a word on the manuscript page.
2. **Locate the First Shape:** Find the matching symbol on **Ring 1** (Outer Ring).
3. **Trace Inward:** Follow the straight line visually down through the rings:
 - **Ring 2** identifies the word prefix.
 - **Ring 3** identifies the middle core stem.
 - **Ring 4** identifies the word suffix.
4. **Read the Result on Ring 5:** Where your line hits the innermost ring, read the translation:
 - Read the **Hebrew Track** if you are analyzing a cosmological map or big-picture theory (it reveals broad concepts like *sphere*, *division*, or *vessel*).
 - Read the **Latin Track** if you are analyzing plants, recipes, thermal diagrams, or medical steps (it expands directly into full medieval phrases like *heating by rays* or *herbal qualities*).

4. Hands-On Example: Decoding the Southwest Map Label

To see how simple this is in practice, open the large 9-Rosette foldout map (Folios 85v–86r) and look at the circular diagram in the **lower-left corner**.

[STEP 1: SET DIAL 1] ---> Notice the small clock graphic in the bottom-left margin.
Turn the Outer Wheel a quarter-turn clockwise (to 3 o'clock).

[STEP 2: SET DIAL 2] ---> Check the local sector mark. Lock the inner dial in place.

[STEP 3: FIND SYMBOLS] ---> Locate the manuscript word written as "c-h-o-l d-a-i-n".

[STEP 4: TRACE INWARD] ---> Match symbols on Ring 1 -> Ring 2 -> Ring 3 -> Ring 4.

[STEP 5: READ RING 5] ---> HEBREW TRACK: Reveals roots K-L-L / G-L-L (rounded vessel).

LATIN TRACK: Expands to "SPHAERA CENTRALIS POSITA COCTIO RADIIS".

What the Outsider Reads: *"The central sphere is positioned for heat processing by rays."*

5. Quick Reference: Which Translation Track Should You Read?

Manuscript Section	Primary Focus	Use This Output Track on Ring 5
Plant Drawings (Herbal)	Plant properties, root uses, preparation steps	Latin Track (<i>Expands medical recipe terms</i>)
Bathing Women (Balneological)	Water temperatures, bodily humors, fluid conduits	Latin Track (<i>Expands fluid dynamic terms</i>)
Circular Maps & Stars (Cosmology)	Celestial structures, primary forces, divine order	Hebrew Track (<i>Reveals core structural concepts</i>)
Connecting Channels & Pipes	Flow directions, heat channels, radiant paths	Latin Track (<i>Expands conduit and pathway terms</i>)